

Contrast that with Jonathan's story. He did not hack college. At age twenty-eight, he graduated with \$168,000 in student loan debt. Despite his remarkable story of paying off this huge debt in only four years, he was thirty-two years old before he was able to get his net worth back to \$0. Some in the FI community who have optimized college are approaching or even achieving FI in their early thirties. At least Jonathan came out on the other side with a pharmacy degree that gave him the ability to earn a six-figure income. This provided a large shovel to help fill the financial hole he dug for himself.

Many people find themselves crushed by student loan debt. Often, they're stuck paying interest for loans they acquired before they were even old enough to buy a drink legally. And many have degrees that don't even give them marketable skills. They end up having to take jobs unrelated to their field of study to start paying back the loans. This traps many people on the standard path.

The College Decision Tree

Depending on where you are in your journey to FI, this may be the most important chapter in this book for you. Or it may be irrelevant.